Mostafa Salari Rad, PhD

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EDUCATION

New School for Social Research, New York, NY 2016
PhD in Cognitive, Social, and Developmental Psychology

Sharif University of Technology, Tehran, Iran 2010
MBA

Amirkabir University of Technology (Tehran Polytechnic), Tehran, Iran 2007
BSc in Computer Engineering

EMPLOYMENT

Principal Investigator, Templeton World Charity Foundation 2022–2026
Understanding the Psychological, Behavioral, and Social Outcomes of the Ramadan Fast
Founder, Jamasp (jamasp.app), 2024–present

Editorial Fellow, Journal of Experimental Psychology: Applied 2026

New School for Social Research, New York, NY 2021–2026
Research Fellow, Department of Psychology
Lecturer in Statistics
Statistics and Research Methods Consultant to Graduate Students

Princeton University, Princeton, NJ 2017–2021
Lecturer, Department of Psychology (2020–2021)
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Kahneman-Treisman Center for Behavioral Science & Public Policy (2017–2019)

New School for Social Research, New York, NY 2016–2017
Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Psychology
Co-founder, Lens (cut.social; github.com/cutsocial/lens), 2018–present

Social & Political Psychology Lab, NSSR, New York, NY 2011–2015
Graduate Research Assistant

FUNDING

Understanding the Psychological, Behavioral, & Social Outcomes of the Ramadan Fast 2022–2026
Principal Investigator — Templeton World Charity Foundation ($499,887). Awarded.

WAVE: Wearable Alignment and Validation Exchange 2026
National Institutes of Health. Under review.

Jamasp: A Platform for Collection & Analysis of Wearable Device Data 2025
RISBS Program, National Science Foundation. In revision.

Cognitive Control, Prosocial Behavior, and Self-deprivation: Lessons from the Ramadan Fast 2024
Principal Investigator — National Science Foundation ($648,194). Submitted; not funded.

AWARDS & HONORS

APS Fund for Teaching and Public Understanding of Psychological Science ($5,000) 2017

New Challenge Social Innovation Initiative, The New School ($5,000) 2015

Sugihara Scholarship 2014

William W. Bradley Scholarship 2011

Dean’s Merit-based Scholarship, New School for Social Research 2010–2014

Idea Award, 2nd Invention and Innovation Symposium, Tehran, Iran 2009

Patent: Anytime Operating System, 1388/7/4-61172, Tehran, Iran 2008

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Rad, M. S. (2026). Misperceptions in protest affect and action among resident and diaspora activists: Online versus on-the-ground in the 2009–2012 Iranian post-election protests. *Journal of Social and Political Psychology*, *14*(1), 193–220. https://doi.org/10.5964/jspp.16905

Rad, M. S. (2025). Self-deprivation and cognition in Ramadan: Could fasting practice improve inhibitory control? *Religion, Brain & Behavior*, 1–26. https://doi.org/10.1080/2153599X.2025.2487277

Rad, M. S. (2024). Ramadan fasting as a goal-pursuit: Why people fast, and how motives affect their experience. *Motivation Science*. https://doi.org/10.1037/mot0000310

Rad, M. S. (2023). From self-deprivation to cooperation: How Ramadan fasting influences risk-aversion and decisions in resource dilemmas. *Current Research in Ecological and Social Psychology*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cresp.2023.100152

Rad, M. S., Ansarinia, M., & Shafir, E. (2022). Temporary self-deprivation can impair cognitive control: Evidence from the Ramadan fast. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*. https://doi.org/10.1177/01461672211070385

Rad, M. S., Shackleford, C., Lee, K. A., Jassin, K., & Ginges, J. (2019). Folk theories of gender and anti-transgender attitudes: Gender differences and policy preferences. *PLoS ONE, 14*(12), e0226967 . https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0226967

Rad, M. S., Martingano, A. J., & Ginges, J. (2018). Toward a psychology of Homo sapiens: Making psychological science more representative of the human population. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 115*(45), 11401–11405. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1721165115

Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. (2018). Folk theories of nationality and anti-immigrant attitudes. *Nature Human Behaviour*, *2*(5), 343–347. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-018-0334-3

Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. (2017). Loss of control is not necessary to induce behavioral consequences of deprivation: The case of religious fasting during Ramadan. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0140525X1700108X

Li, M., Leidner, B., Petrović, N., Orazani, S. N., & Rad, M. S. (2017). The role of retributive justice and the use of international criminal justice in post-conflict reconciliation. *European Journal of Social Psychology*. https://doi.org/10.1002/ejsp.2326

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Rad, M. S. Private rituals, public in mind, and the shifting scope of religious prosociality: Evidence from Ramadan. Under review at *PNAS Nexus*. [Preprint]

Rad, M. S., & Radmanesh, A. Collecting data from wearable-device owners via crowdsourcing platforms: Architecture and feasibility. Under review at *Behavior Research Methods*. [Preprint]

PREPRINTS

Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. Directional Asymmetry in Reasoning About National and Religious Identity Is Category-Specific: Evidence From Palestine, Israel, and the United States. [Preprint]

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION (Tentative Titles)

Ramadan and Self-Regulation

Rad, M. S. Physiological signatures of the Ramadan fast: Evidence from consumer wearable devices.

Rad, M. S. Mapping the cognitive footprints of the Ramadan fast: Task switching, working memory, inhibitory control, and impulsivity.

Rad, M. S. Could practicing temporary self-deprivation make you grateful and/or generous? Studies on gratitude and Ramadan.

Rad, M. S. Ramadan and goal pursuit: Impact of ritual on personal goals.

Rad, M. S. Religious fasting and cognitive performance: A meta-analysis across traditions and practices.

Folk Theories, Social Categories, and Nationality

Rad, M. S. Essentialism of social categories in adults: A review of methods and samples.

Rad, M. S. Perceptions of the ideal immigrant: Low in confidence, high in tolerance.

Lehner, A., Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. Beyond race and gender: Nationality as the frontier of exclusion and source of privilege.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

New School for Social Research

Advanced Statistics Spring 2022, 2023
Designed syllabus and taught a comprehensive course in PhD-level statistics.

Introduction to Statistics and Research Methods Fall 2021
Designed syllabus and taught MA-level statistics and research methods.

Introduction to Statistics & Research Methods 2019
Designed syllabus and taught MA-level psychology statistics and research methods.

Fundamentals of Social Psychology Spring 2019
Designed syllabus and taught undergraduate social psychology, Lang College.

Political Psychology (graduate) Spring 2017
Designed syllabus and held a transdisciplinary seminar at the intersection of social psychology, political science, economics, and anthropology.

Political Psychology (undergraduate) Fall 2014, Spring 2016
Designed syllabus and taught a beginner's version of the graduate course, emphasizing methods and research tools.

Judgment & Decision-Making Fall 2015
Designed and taught a course on decision making with emphasis on design applications.

Princeton University

Psychology of Prejudice: Causes, Cures, and Consequences (with Dr. Stacey Sinclair) Spring 2021, Fall 2018

Psychology 101 (with Dr. Emily Pronin) Fall 2020
Taught three lab sections; developed seven writing assignments for the full course.

Psychology of Judgment and Decision Making (with Dr. Eldar Shafir) Fall 2017
Taught six precepts.

Teaching Fellowships and Assistantships

Introduction to Social Psychology; Fieldwork in Social & Political Psychology (with Dr. Jeremy Ginges) Spring 2015

Social Psychology (graduate) — Dr. Emanuele Castano Fall 2015

Body & Cognition (graduate) — Dr. Daniel Casasanto Fall 2012

Principles of Marketing; Human Resource Management (MBA) 2008–2009

INVITED TALKS

Self-Control: Collective Practices, Lay Beliefs, and Prosociality. Insights from the Ramadan Fast. Department of Psychology, The New School for Social Research. December 2024.

Learning from a diverse psychological science: Studies on Ramadan fasting. Psychology Seminar Series, Queen Mary University of London. March 2023.

Understanding the psychological, behavioral, and social outcomes of the Ramadan fast. The Science of Religious and Spiritual Exercises, Templeton World Charity Foundation Convention, San Diego, CA. January 2023.

Self-deprivation effects on cognition and cooperation: Evidence from the Ramadan fast. University of Southern California, CA. April 2021.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

APS 2026 Annual Convention — **Symposium chair**. Accepted. Not attended due to travel and visa disruptions.

International Conference on Social Dilemmas (ICSD), Japan 2026 — **Talk** accepted. Same reason as above.

Practice improved inhibitory control: Insights from the Ramadan fast. **Speaker.** Society of Experimental Social Psychology (SESP), October 2023, Madison, WI.

Taking on new identities, keeping old ones: Cross-cultural patterns of reasoning about nationality, religion, and gender. **Speaker.** Self & Identity Preconference, Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), February 2022, San Francisco, CA.

Ramadan influences cognitive control, risk-taking, and cooperative behavior in resource dilemmas: Is communal deprivation a response to scarcity? **Speaker.** SESP, October 2021, Santa Barbara, CA.

Ramadan, risk-taking, and cooperation in resource dilemmas: Communal deprivation as a cultural response to scarcity? **Flash Talk.** Association for Psychological Science (APS) Virtual Convention, May 2021.

Immigration, nationality, and the question of who belongs. **Symposium Chair & Speaker.** 32nd APS Convention, May 2020, Chicago, IL.

Strangers in a new land: Perceptions and treatment of immigrants. **Speaker.** Society for the Psychological Study of Social Issues (SPSSI), June 2019, San Diego, CA.

Nationality, immigrants, and refugees: A social, cognitive, and developmental analysis. **Symposium Chair & Speaker.** SESP, October 2018, Seattle, WA.

Religion, essences, and identity transformation. **Speaker.** SESP, October 2016, Santa Monica, CA.

Nationalist essentialism predicts attitudes against immigrants in a cross-national data set. **Speaker.** APS Convention, May 2016, Chicago, IL.

The effect of psychological distance on inter-group perception and interpretation of events: The case of Iranians' protest of President Ahmadinejad's re-election. **Speaker.** International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP), July 2012, Chicago, IL.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

International Conference on Social Dilemmas (ICSD), Amsterdam, Netherlands 2024.

Rad, M. S., & Shafir, E. (2018, November). How fasting affects cognition and decision making: A study of Muslims fasting during Ramadan. Society for Judgment and Decision Making, New Orleans, LA.

Rad, M. S., Ansarinia, M., & Ginges, J. (2016, November). Introducing Cut: An online platform for conducting synchronous interactive experiments. SJDM, Boston, MA. https://doi.org/10.23668/psycharchives.22649

Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. (2015, November). Sticky nationalities: The essences of national identities are easy to gain but difficult to lose. SJDM, Chicago, IL.

Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. (2014, November). Effects of self-imposed scarcity on decision making. SJDM, Long Beach, CA.

Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. (2014, February). Sacred time: Temporal discounting of sacred values. SPSP, Austin, TX; also APS Convention, 2014, Denver, CO.

Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. (2014, February). Essentialism of national and religious categories. SPSP, Austin, TX; also APS Convention, 2014, Denver, CO; SJDM, 2013, Toronto, Canada.

Rad, M. S., & Ginges, J. (2011, February). Positive emotional reconstruction of past committed action: Evidence from 2009 post-election protests in Iran. SPSP, San Antonio, TX.

Black, J., Ginges, J., & Rad, M. S. (2017, February). Attributing essentialist beliefs about nationality to immigrants in America. SPSP, San Antonio, TX.

EDITORIAL SERVICE

Editorial Fellow, *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Applied*

Reviewer: *Science; Nature Human Behaviour; Nature Reviews Psychology; Psychological Science; Journal of Personality and Social Psychology; Journal of Experimental Psychology: General; Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin; Journal of Research in Personality; Evolution and Human Behavior; Clinical Psychologist; Australian Journal of Social Issues; Religion, Brain & Behavior.*

Affiliations: Society for Personality and Social Psychology; Society for Judgment and Decision Making; American Psychological Association

SKILLS

Statistics: Data analysis in R (15+ years). Parametric hypothesis testing, nonparametric bootstrapping, multilevel linear and nonlinear mixed-effects models, time series analysis, cross-validation, multidimensional scaling, advanced data visualization, open science practices.

Programming: R (tidyverse, lme4, lmerTest, dabest, Superpower), Python (pandas, SciPy, statsmodels, NumPy), SQL, JSON parsing, shell scripting.

Research methods: Experimental and survey design, causal inference (difference-in-differences, propensity score matching), randomized controlled trials, longitudinal and multi-wave field studies, behavioral telemetry, cross-cultural instrument design and deployment (Prolific, MTurk).

Platforms: Amazon Web Services, Google Cloud Platform, Qualtrics.

Languages: English (fluent; TOEFL iBT 119), Persian (native), Japanese (basic).

REFERENCES

Available on request.